

**UNIT
12**

COMPREHENSIONS

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Passage 1 The Road That's The 'Eighth World Wonder'

The **Karakoram Highway (KKH)** is a breathtaking 1,300-kilometre road that passes through some of the most astonishing mountain landscapes on Earth. Known as the "Eighth Wonder of the World," it connects Pakistan and China, making it one of the highest and most scenic highways in the world.



The highway begins in Hasan Abdal, near Islamabad, and extends to Kashgar in China's Xinjiang region, crossing the Khunjerab Pass, which stands at an altitude of about 4,700 metres. This high-altitude pass is the highest paved border crossing in the world.

Construction of the KKH was a massive undertaking. Originally part of the ancient Silk Road, the highway was built over two decades, starting in 1959 and completed in 1978. More than 24,000 Pakistani and Chinese workers worked together to construct this marvel, bringing trade, tourism, and convenience to remote areas.

One of the most beautiful stretches of the KKH is the 194-kilometre section through Pakistan's Hunza Valley. Surrounded by the majestic Karakoram Mountains, this area is home to stunning glaciers, sparkling alpine lakes, and towering snow-covered peaks. The Hunza Valley, often referred to as "Shangri-La," is not only known for its natural beauty but also for its warm and welcoming people, rich traditions, and unique culture.

The Karakoram Highway is more than just a road; it is a journey through history, culture, and the wonders of nature. It remains a symbol of the friendship between Pakistan and China and a lifeline for the communities it connects.

Questions

1. What is the Karakoram Highway, according to the passage?
2. Why is the Karakoram Highway called the "Eighth Wonder of the World"?
3. Name three natural features mentioned in the passage that can be seen along the highway.
4. How did the construction of the Karakoram Highway benefit the region?
5. How would a traveler describe the Hunza Valley, based on the passage?
6. Identify 4 adjectives and 2 adverbs in the passage above.

Passage 2 How School Libraries Can Foster a Reading Culture

School libraries play a vital role in developing a love for reading among students. By providing access to a wide variety of books, school libraries create an environment that encourages curiosity, imagination, and a lifelong habit of learning. Whether it's fiction, non-fiction, or reference materials, a library caters to the diverse interests and needs of students, making reading an enjoyable and rewarding experience.



One way school libraries foster a reading culture is by offering a comfortable and welcoming space for students to explore books. A well-designed library with cozy reading corners, colourful displays, and quiet zones can inspire students to spend more time with books. Additionally, school librarians can play an important role by guiding students to age-appropriate and engaging reading materials, helping them discover genres and authors that spark their interest.

Libraries also contribute to a reading culture through events and activities such as book fairs, reading challenges, and storytelling sessions. These activities not only make reading fun but also build a sense of community among students who share similar interests. Digital libraries and access to e-books have further enhanced the accessibility of reading materials, ensuring that students can enjoy books anytime, anywhere.

In today's fast-paced world, where distractions like social media and video games are common, school libraries offer a refuge for quiet reflection and personal growth. By fostering a love for reading, they equip students with

critical thinking skills, improve language proficiency, and expand their knowledge. In essence, school libraries are not just about books—they are gateways to a world of endless possibilities.

Questions

1. What role do school libraries play in fostering a love for reading?
2. How does a well-designed library encourage students to spend more time reading?
3. What are some activities mentioned in the passage that help promote a reading culture?
4. How can school librarians assist students in developing a habit of reading?
5. What impact do digital libraries and e-books have on students' access to reading materials?
6. Why are school libraries important in today's fast-paced world?
7. How do school libraries contribute to students' personal growth and critical thinking skills?
8. Identify 3 nouns, 2 verbs, and 2 adjectives from the passage above.

Passage 3 Natural Disasters and Their Impact on Human Lives

Natural disasters are sudden and extreme events caused by natural processes that can cause significant damage to human life, property, and the environment. Examples of natural disasters include earthquakes, hurricanes, floods, tsunamis, droughts, and volcanic eruptions. These disasters often strike without warning, leaving communities vulnerable and in need of urgent help.



The impact of natural disasters on human lives can be devastating. They can cause loss of life, injuries, and displacement of people. For example, earthquakes can destroy buildings and infrastructure, leaving families homeless. Floods can wash away homes, roads, and crops, leading to food shortages and health crises. Hurricanes and cyclones bring strong winds and heavy rains, causing widespread destruction in coastal areas.

Beyond the immediate physical damage, natural disasters have long-term effects on mental health and economic stability. Survivors often face trauma, anxiety, and loss of loved ones. Rebuilding homes, schools, and hospitals can take years, affecting education, healthcare, and livelihoods.

However, preparedness and disaster management can reduce the impact

of these events. Early warning systems, emergency response plans, and community education help save lives. Countries that invest in disaster-resilient infrastructure and effective evacuation plans are better equipped to handle such events.

Natural disasters remind us of the power of nature and the importance of working together to protect lives and rebuild stronger communities.

Questions

1. What are natural disasters, and can you name three examples?
2. How do natural disasters affect people's homes and infrastructure?
3. What are some long-term effects of natural disasters on survivors?
4. Why is disaster preparedness important?
5. What can communities do to reduce the impact of natural disasters?
6. Identify 3 nouns, 2 adverbs, and 1 adjective from the passage.
7. Do you think governments should spend more money on disaster management? Why or why not?

Passage 4 Deforestation: Causes and Consequences

Deforestation refers to the large-scale removal of forests, often to make way for agriculture, urban development, or logging. Forests cover about 31% of the Earth's land, and they play a vital role in maintaining ecological balance. However, deforestation continues to happen at an alarming rate, causing serious environmental problems.



One of the main causes of deforestation is the need for agricultural land. As the global population grows, forests are cleared to create space for crops and livestock. Logging for timber and paper, urban expansion, and mining are other significant reasons. In many regions, forests are burned or cut down to meet the growing demand for resources.

The consequences of deforestation are severe. One major effect is the loss of biodiversity, as many plant and animal species lose their habitats. Deforestation also contributes to climate change by increasing the amount of carbon dioxide in the atmosphere. Trees absorb carbon dioxide and release oxygen, so their removal leads to higher greenhouse gas levels, causing global warming.

Furthermore, deforestation can result in soil erosion, where the top layer of fertile soil is washed away, making the land unsuitable for farming. It also disrupts the water cycle, leading to less rainfall and drier climates. Communities that depend on forests for their livelihoods are also negatively impacted.

Efforts to combat deforestation include reforestation (planting new trees), sustainable farming practices, and creating protected forest areas. Raising awareness about the importance of forests can also encourage individuals and governments to take action.

Questions

1. What is deforestation, and why does it happen?
2. Name two main causes of deforestation mentioned in the passage.
3. How does deforestation affect plant and animal species?
4. What is the role of trees in controlling carbon dioxide levels?
5. How does deforestation lead to soil erosion?
6. What are two solutions to combat deforestation mentioned in the passage?
7. Identify 3 nouns, 2 verbs, and 1 adjective from the passage.
8. In your opinion, why is it important to stop deforestation?

Passage 5 The Role of Social Media in Shaping Public Opinion

Social media has become a powerful force in shaping public opinion in the modern world. Platforms like Facebook, Twitter, Instagram, and TikTok provide people with instant access to information, news, and diverse perspectives from around the globe. With billions of users engaging daily, social media influences how individuals perceive and react to various issues, from politics and social justice to cultural trends and global events.



One key way social media shapes public opinion is by amplifying voices and ideas that might otherwise remain unheard. It provides a platform for marginalized groups, activists, and independent thinkers to share their views and reach a wider audience. Viral posts and hashtags can spark global conversations, raise awareness about critical issues, and even lead to social or political change.

However, the impact of social media is not always positive. Misinformation and fake news can spread quickly, creating confusion and influencing

opinions based on false narratives. Algorithms often create echo chambers, where users are exposed only to content that aligns with their existing beliefs, limiting open-minded discussion.

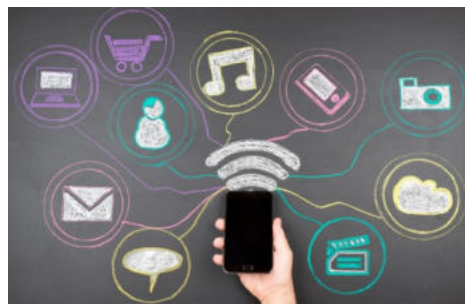
Despite these challenges, social media has undoubtedly revolutionized the way public opinion is shaped. It has made communication more democratic, giving everyone a voice. To harness its potential effectively, users must develop critical thinking skills and verify information before forming opinions or sharing content. By doing so, social media can continue to serve as a tool for positive change and informed public discourse.

Questions

1. What is one way social media helps people get information?
2. Does social media allow marginalized people to share their opinions?
3. Give one example of how hashtags can create change.
4. What are two negative effects of social media mentioned in the passage?
5. Do algorithms limit what people see on social media?
6. Why is it important to check information before sharing it on social media?
7. Identify 3 action words (verbs), 2 describing words (adjectives), and 1 adverb in the passage.
8. In your opinion, should social media be trusted? Why or why not?

Passage 6 How Technology Has Changed Communication

Technology has completely transformed the way people communicate. In the past, letters and face-to-face conversations were the main ways of staying in touch. Today, with the rise of the internet and smartphones, communication has become faster, easier, and more convenient.



One major change is the use of instant messaging apps and emails. These allow people to send messages across the world in seconds. Social media platforms like WhatsApp, Facebook, and Instagram make it easy to share updates, photos, and videos with friends and family, no matter where they are.

Video calls are another significant advancement. They allow people to see and talk to each other in real time, making communication more personal and engaging, even over long distances. For example, students can attend online classes, and families can stay connected despite living in different countries.

However, these changes also have some drawbacks. Many people spend too much time on their devices, which can lead to less face-to-face interaction. There is also the risk of spreading misinformation and losing privacy.

Despite these challenges, technology has made communication more accessible and efficient, bringing people closer together and connecting the world like never before.

Questions

1. How has technology made communication faster and easier?
2. What are two examples of communication tools mentioned in the passage?
3. Does video calling make communication more personal? (Yes/No)
4. How do social media platforms help people stay connected?
5. Name one drawback of using technology for communication.
6. What is one way technology benefits families living in different countries?
7. Identify 2 nouns, 2 verbs, and 1 adjective from the passage.
8. In your opinion, has technology improved communication overall? Why or why not?